



New wireless keys

Logitech is making typing a lot more fun with the new K480

<http://dgit.in/K480kybrd>

Agent 001

could help me with model numbers or with the required specs within the budget.

– Johith Ommen Iype

A Hi Johith, Seems like you want to have the best of both worlds – great gaming performance alongside long battery life. Unfortunately, these two requirements don't go hand in hand. A performance-heavy machine will directly impact the battery-life of a laptop, therefore very rarely do “gaming or entertainment” laptops with a Core i5 processor, 4 GB RAM and 2 GB discrete graphics have batteries that last more than a few hours of non-stop gaming. However, taking all of your needs into account, in ascending order of recommendations, here's what we think you should buy:

HP Pavilion 15-P210tx – packs in quite the performance at the price. All the latest internal hardware that you'd want is also present. Acer E1-572G – comes with 8 GB of RAM and AMD graphics (slightly slower than what the HP packs). There are a few offerings from Dell, Lenovo and ASUS but those are slightly out of your budget, and don't offer great value for money compared to the above two recommendations at this point of time.

Need an upgrade

Hi Team Digit, the super awesome tech magazine. I am Pranav (15 yrs old) and I've been reading Digit for the past few months and now it's seriously difficult to imagine technology awareness without it. I have some suggestions and also some questions to ask and I would be very pleased if you could answer them.

I want to know if I can run Assassin's Creed Unity and GTA V on my Dell Inspiron 15 laptop. Specs are as follows:

- Processor: Intel Core i5 @ 2.2 GHz;
- RAM: 8 GB;
- Storage: 1 TB;
- Graphics Card: Nvidia GeForce 820M 2 GB;

Please tell me if I'll be able to run these games smoothly or whether some amount of lag and stuttering will be experienced. If you think that they'll be not playable altogether, then please do provide some budget friendly solutions.

– Pranav Singh

A Hi Pranav, The Dell Inspiron 15 that you're using won't be able to cut it when it comes to playing the current crop of games. You might be able to run them at the lowest settings but your gameplay experience won't be that great (obviously). It's better if you invest in a new laptop or assemble a PC for yourself. Since you didn't give information on the exact budget that you have in mind for an upgrade, we'll suggest that you buy a new laptop like the Lenovo Y50-70 which although isn't cheap (₹77,800), it'll be enough for playing the games that you want to. A better budget friendly alternative would be to build a PC which would provide more performance per rupee and the flexibility to upgrade easily later on. Take a look at the mid-range rig in our Killer Rigs section and select the best configuration depending upon your budget. **4**

COMMUNICATING THROUGH SKETCHES

Nowadays the game designer's role in the industry is multiple. The job requires a large variety of knowledge about software, tools, and technics to provide all which is needed in a game: rules, mechanisms, scoring, difficulty curve, balancing, scripting, prototyping...

But above all of this, the game designer has to be efficient when (s)he proposes an idea. Sketching is one of the skill which is often a necessity now. A good sketch is better than a long speech. It can be done everywhere, including meetings. It takes only few minutes to be done, and then the debate about evaluation or feasibility can start. The idea can be improved, modified or thrown away, without writing an important technical documentation.



Keep in mind that drawing is an international language, sketches can be easily understood by all members of the team, not only artists but also programmers, producers, and can apply to all game design topics: rules, gameplay sequences and puzzles.

Many times, game designers claim they are not 'artists', this is true and they don't have to compete with real artists. GD sketching is not 'Art' in the sense of good drawing, good colour choices or perfect camera angle. In fact we don't need to care as much about these! Also avoid thinking if people are not going to mock the awkward style of your drawing, don't be mentally blocked by this point. Draw! And the more you do this exercise the better your drawing skill is going to be, so feel free to do it the way that suits you.

GD Sketching, at its core, is about presenting, communicating an idea. To do so, you have to define your idea then to write it as a sequence of 3 to 5 steps (or all in one scene). Draw a common frame size for each step then sketch this and here is the action!

In conclusion the Game designer's work is mostly based on a good communication with team members coming from different departments using their own languages. So learn to communicate, use sketches. Et voila!

By Philippe Tesson, Game Design Trainer

For more visit www.dsk.digit.in.